

Circa 1620. Francis Bacon’s work espouses the idea that humans have dominion over nature, a view that is later termed “imperial ecology”.

1789. Gilbert White’s Natural History and Antiquities of Selborne records in great detail the wildlife around his rural home.

1854. Written in a cabin in the woods, Henry David Thoreau’s book Walden presents a romanticised view of the natural world.

1864. George Perkins Marsh warns of the destructive impact that human action is having on nature.

1883. The first working photovoltaic solar cell panel is built by inventor Charles Fritts in the US.